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Inventor(s)	Son; Myunghee

Light-scattering fine dust measurement apparatus

Abstract

A light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus is disclosed. The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the present invention comprises: a casing provided with an inlet into which outside air flows and an outlet through which is exhausted measured air of which the particulate matter concentration has been measured; an airflow pathway which connects the inlet and the outlet in the casing and along which outside air moves; and an external temperature-humidity sensor which is provided on the outside of the casing and measures the temperature and relative humidity of outside air.

Inventors:	Son; Myunghee (Daejeon, KR)
Applicant:	GONGGAM SENSORS CO., LTD. (Daejeon, KR)
Family ID:	1000008818405
Assignee:	GONGAM SENSORS CO., LTD. (Daejeon, KR)
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Primary Examiner: Alam; Uzma

Assistant Examiner: Van Cleave; Justin J

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Quantum Patent Law Firm

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This patent application is a U.S. national stage application of International Application No. PCT/KR2021/009656, filed Jul. 26, 2021 and the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference, which claims priority to KR 10-2020-0098351, filed Aug. 6, 2020 and KR 10-2021-0093052, filed Jul. 15, 2021, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present invention relates to particulate matter measuring apparatus and, more specifically, to particulate matter measuring apparatus capable of accurately measuring the concentration of particulate matter contained in the air by using a light scattering particulate matter sensor.

BACKGROUND ART

(3) A light scattering method particulate matter measuring apparatus is used to measure the concentration of particulate matter in the air. In a light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus, a monochromatic beam is directed to the particle and then a detector records the scattered light at a certain angle.

(4) In general, a conventional light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus includes a plurality of detectors for detecting lights scattered by aerosol particles and measures the concentration of particulate matter by averaging the measured values during standard time.

(5) However, when the relative humidity in the air is increased, water vapor condenses on hygroscopic particulate matter surfaces readily and then the particulate matter is deliquescent. Water adsorption onto and absorption by aerosol particles increases their size.

(6) That is, the higher the relative humidity, the larger the particle size of the hygroscopic particulate matter. So, the conventional light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus may mistake fine particulate matter for particulate matter, and the particulate matter increased in size is not measured as particulate matter since being considered the coarse particulate matter.

(7) The above-described light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus can measure in real time and is inexpensive, but has a disadvantage in that the measurement value according to the relative humidity is low in accuracy as mentioned above.

(8) Therefore, a light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus for controlling the relative humidity of introduced air using a heater has been developed. However, the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus using a heater requires a vacuum pump to introduce ambient air thereinto since an inlet is arranged at the uppermost portion, requires lots of time and energy since lowering the relative humidity in an indirect heating method, and is bulky.

(9) Furthermore, the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus has another disadvantage in that even if the relative humidity is known, the concentration of particulate matter cannot be predicted and corrected because the composition of particulate matter differs from place to place and hygroscopic properties are different depending on the composition of particulate matter.

(10) Additionally, the conventional light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus has a disadvantage in that the particulate matter contained in the air introduced through the inlet adheres to the inlet by static electricity and thus cannot accurately measure the concentration.

DISCLOSURE

Technical Problem

(11) Accordingly, the present invention has been made in view of the above-mentioned problems occurring in the related art, and it is an object of the present invention to provide a light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus capable of accurately measuring an amount of particulate matter contained in the air in a light scattering method regardless of relative humidity in the air.

(12) It is another object of the present invention to provide a light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus capable of improving accuracy in particulate matter measurement by minimizing generation of static electricity.

Technical Solution

(13) To accomplish the above-mentioned objects, according to the present invention, there is provided a light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus including: a casing provided with an inlet into which outside air flows, and an outlet through which measurement air of which the particulate matter concentration has been measured is discharged; an airflow passage which connects the inlet and the outlet in the casing and through which outside air moves; an external temperature-humidity sensor disposed outside the casing to measure temperature and relative humidity of the outside air; a heater disposed on the airflow passage near the inlet.

(14) In this instance, the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus further includes: a light scattering particulate matter sensor disposed on the airflow passage between the heater and the outlet to measure particulate matter concentration of the measurement air that flows through the heater; and an internal temperature-humidity sensor disposed on the airflow passage between the heater and the light scattering particulate matter sensor to measure temperature and relative humidity of the measurement air.

Advantageous Effects

(15) The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the present invention is capable of lowering relative humidity and increasing accuracy in concentration measurement of particulate matter by heating outside air by a heater when the relative humidity of the outside air is high.

(16) In addition, an antistatic layer is formed on the inner wall surface of the airflow passage through which the outside air flows, or the airflow passage is made of an antistatic material. Accordingly, the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the present invention can prevent particulate matter from sticking to the inflow passage due to static electricity, thereby solving the problem that there is an error in the particulate matter measurement result.

(17) Additionally, the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the present invention has the insulation layer formed on the inner wall surface of the sensing passage extending from the heater to the light scattering particulate matter sensor, thereby minimizing heat loss of the measured air having increased temperature, and securing reliability in the measurement result of the particulate matter concentration.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view illustrating a configuration of a light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to a preferred embodiment of the present invention.

(2) FIG. 2 is a side cross-sectional view of the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the preferred embodiment of the present invention.

(3) FIG. 3 is a front cross-sectional view of the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the preferred embodiment of the present invention.

(4) FIG. 4 is a block diagram schematically illustrating a configuration of the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the preferred embodiment of the present invention.

(5) FIGS. 5 to 7 are views illustrating various modifications of an airflow passage of the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the preferred embodiment of the present invention.

(6) FIG. 8 is a flow chart illustrating a particulate matter measurement process of the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the preferred embodiment of the present invention.

EXPLANATION OF REFERENCE NUMERALS

(7) **100**: light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **110**: casing **111**: inlet block **111a**: inlet **113**: outlet block **113a**: outlet **113b**: first fastening member **115**: heating block **115a**: second fastening member **117**: sensing block **119**: spacer **120**: airflow passage **121**: inflow passage **121a**: antistatic layer **123**: heating passage **124**: connection passage **125**: sensing passage **125a**: insulation layer **127**: outlet passage **130**: heater **140**: external temperature-humidity sensor **150**: internal temperature-humidity sensor **160**: light scattering particulate matter sensor **170**: air flow fan **180**: control unit **181**: connector **A1**: outside air **A2**: measurement air **T1**: external temperature **T2**: internal temperature **Tt**: target temperature **W1**: external relative humidity **W2**: internal relative humidity **Wt**: target relative humidity

MODE FOR INVENTION

(8) Hereinafter, preferred embodiments of the present invention will now be described in detail with reference to the attached drawings, in which like reference numbers denote corresponding parts throughout the drawings.

(9) The terms “comprising” and “including” in the discussion directed to the present invention and the claims are used in an open-ended fashion and thus should be interpreted to mean “including”, but not limited thereto.

(10) FIG. 1 is a perspective view illustrating a configuration of a light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **100** according to a preferred embodiment of the present invention, FIG. 2 is a side cross-sectional view of the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **100** according to the preferred embodiment of the present invention, FIG. 3 is a front cross-sectional view of the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **100** according to the preferred embodiment of the present invention, and FIG. 4 is a block diagram schematically illustrating a configuration of the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **100** according to the preferred embodiment of the present invention.

(11) As illustrated in the drawings, the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **100** according to the preferred embodiment of the present invention includes: a casing **110** having an inlet **111a** through which outside air **A1** flows and an outlet **113a** through which measurement air **A2** is discharged; an airflow passage **120** which connects the inlet **111a** and the outlet **113a** inside the casing **110** and guides the outside air to be discharged out after concentration of particulate matter is measured; a heater **130** provided on the inlet **111a**; an external temperature-humidity sensor **140** disposed outside the casing **110** to measure temperature and relative humidity of the outside air; an internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** disposed above the heater **130** to measure temperature and relative humidity of the measurement air **A2** heated by the heater **130**; a light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** disposed between the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** and the outlet **113a** to measure the particulate matter concentration of the measurement air **A2** in a light scattering method; and a control unit **180** selectively operating the heater **130** according to the relative humidity of the outside air **A1** measured by the external temperature-humidity sensor **140** to reduce the relative humidity of the outside air **A1**.

(12) As illustrated in FIG. 2, the outside air **A1** is supplied from the outside of the casing **110** through the inlet **111a**, and has external temperature **T1** and external relative humidity **W1**.

(13) The measurement air **A2** gets in contact with the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** and refers to air in which the particulate matter concentration is measured, and has internal temperature **T2** and internal relative humidity **W2**.

(14) The measurement air **A2** may have the same temperature and relative humidity as the outside air **A1** according to the relative humidity of the outside air **A1** ($T1=T2$, $W1=W2$), or the outside air **A1** may be heated by the heater **130** ($T2>T1$, $W2<W1$).

(15) In the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **100** according to the present invention, the heater **130** selectively heats the outside air **A1** according to the relative humidity of the outside air **A1** to lower the relative humidity of the outside air **A1**, thereby improving accuracy in particulate matter measurement with respect to the measured air **A2**.

(16) The casing **110** supports each of the components so that the particulate matter concentration can be measured by the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** after the outside air **A1** is introduced. The casing **110** includes an inlet block **111** having an inlet **111a**, an outlet block **113** having an outlet **113a**, a heating block **115** in which the heater **130** is accommodated, a sensing block **117** in which the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** is accommodated, and a spacer **119** disposed between the heating block **115** and the sensing block **117** to support the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150**.

(17) The airflow passage **120** is formed in the casing **110** and connects the inlet **111a** and the outlet **113a** to form a closed path. As illustrated in FIGS. 2 and 3, the airflow passage **120** includes an inflow passage **121** guiding the outside air **A1** introduced into the inlet **111a** to the heating block **115**, a heating passage **123** formed in the heating block **115** to guide the outside air **A1** to flow to the spacer **119** after passing through the heater **130**, a connection passage **124** guiding the measurement air **A2** passing through the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** to an inlet of the sensing block **117**, a sensing passage **125** formed in the sensing block **117** to guide the measurement air **A2** passing through the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** to the outlet block **113**, and an outlet passage **127** formed in the outlet block **113** to guide the measurement air **A2** passing through the sensing passage **125** to the outlet **113a**.

(18) The inlet block **111** is arranged at the lowermost portion of the casing **110** to allow the outside air **A1** to flow into the casing **110**. The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **100** according to a preferred embodiment of the present invention has a structure in which the inlet **111a** is located at a lower portion thereof and the outlet **113a** is located at an upper portion thereof. In addition, the heater **130**, the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150**, and the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** are sequentially arranged upward from the lower portion along the airflow passage **120** ranging from the inlet **111a** to the outlet **113a**.

(19) Accordingly, even though there is no driving force, such as a vacuum pump, that consumes a large amount of energy for introducing the outside air **A1** by forcedly forming negative pressure therein, the outside air **A1** may be naturally introduced by the convection phenomenon of the air heated by the heater **130**, and then, can flow upward to be moved to the heating passage **115**.

(20) A small-sized air flow fan **170** for discharging the measurement air **A2** to the outside through the sensing block **117** is preferably provided in a route from the heating passage **115** to the outlet **113a**. The small-sized air flow fan **170** is combined with the sensing block **117** to create an air flow through which the measurement air **A2** can be discharged to the outside. In this instance, it is preferable that the small-sized air flow fan **170** is provided in a form in which a flow meter capable of measuring a flow rate of the measuring air **A2** moving inside is combined integrally.

(21) In FIG. 2, the inlet **111a** is formed on the front surface of the inlet block **111**, and the inflow passage **121** is formed in a curved shape inside the inlet block **111** to prevent the heater **130** from being exposed to the outside. In general, since the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **100** is installed outdoors, it is preferable that the inflow passage **121** is formed in a curved shape or a complicated shape that is vertically winding so as not to come into contact with the heater **130**.

(22) Here, in order to prevent particulate matter contained in the outside air **A1** introduced into the inlet **111a** from being adhered onto the inner wall surface by static electricity, the inflow passage **121** has an antistatic layer **121a** formed on the inner wall surface thereof.

(23) The antistatic layer **121a** may be formed by coating a material with a predetermined thickness having an antistatic function that does not generate static electricity so that particulate matter contained in the outside air **A1** is not adhered onto the inner wall surface of a pipeline of the inflow passage **121** by static electricity. The material having an antistatic function may be one among various known materials.

(24) The antistatic layer **121a** may be formed on the heating passage **123**, the connection passage **124**, and the sensing passage **125** as well as the inflow passage **121**.

(25) In addition, without forming the antistatic layer **121a**, the inlet block **111**, the heating block **115**, the spacer **119**, and the sensing block **117** may be made of a material having the antistatic function.

(26) The heating block **115** is combined with an upper portion of the inlet block **111** and accommodates the heater **130** therein. A heating passage **123** is formed inside the heating block **115** to communicate with the inflow passage **121** and the connection passage **124**. The heating block **115** is combined with the inlet block **111** by a second fastening member **115a**.

(27) The heater **130** is selectively operated by the control of the control unit **180** and heats the outside air **A1** that flows along the heating passage **123**. As illustrated in FIG. 3, the heater **130** is provided to correspond to the entire width of the heating passage **123** and gets in contact with the outside air **A1** that flows along the heating passage **123**. The heater **130** is provided as a hot wire coil wound several times along the width of the heating passage **123** to increase a contact area with the outside air **A1** to heat the outside air **A1** in a short time.

(28) The width of the heating passage **123** is equal to or wider than the inflow passage **121** so as to maximize the contact area between the heater **130** and the outside air **A1**. When the width of the heating passage **123** is wider than the width **W1** of the inflow passage **121**, a flow rate of the outside air **A1** is slowed and contact time with the heater **130** is increased, thereby enabling more efficient heating.

(29) The spacer **119** is arranged between the heating block **115** and the sensing block **117** so that the internal temperature humidity sensor **150** is spaced apart from the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160**. The connection passage **124** is formed inside the spacer **119**, and the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** is arranged inside the connection passage **124**.

(30) The spacer **119** is positioned between the heating block **115** and the sensing block **117** to prevent the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** from blocking an entrance of the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** and hindering a smooth flow of the air when the measurement air **A2** moved from the heating passage **123** is moved to the sensing passage **125** via the internal temperature humidity sensor **150**.

(31) As illustrated in FIG. 2, the external temperature-humidity sensor **140** is provided at one side of the inlet **111a** to measure external temperature **T1** and external relative humidity **W1** of the outside air **A1** flowing into the inlet **111a**. According to the control of the control unit **180**, the external temperature-humidity sensor **140** can measure either the external temperature or the external relative humidity, or can measure both the external temperature and the external relative humidity.

(32) As illustrated in FIG. 3, the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** is arranged in a boundary area between the heating passage **123** and the sensing passage **125** to measure the internal temperature **T2** or the internal relative humidity **W2** of the measurement air **A2** passing through the heater **130**.

(33) Although not illustrated in the drawings, the external temperature-humidity sensor **140** and the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** are electrically connected to the control unit **180** to transmit the external temperature, the external relative humidity, the internal temperature, and the internal relative humidity, which have been measured, to the control unit **180**.

(34) The sensing block **117** is disposed above the inlet block **111** and has the sensing passage **125** formed therein. The sensing passage **125** is provided with the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** to measure the concentration of particulate matter contained in the measurement air **A2** that flows along the sensing passage **125**.

(35) Here, it is preferable that the sensing passage **125** is designed in such a way that the measurement air **A2** heated to lower the relative humidity in the heater **130** maintains the heated internal temperature **T2** and can get in contact with the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160**.

(36) Therefore, the sensing passage **125** according to the preferred embodiment of the present

invention is designed such that the width D2 of the pipeline gets significantly narrower than the width D1 of the heating passage **123** as illustrated in FIG. 3, thereby rapidly controlling the flow rate of the measurement air A2 moved along the sensing passage **125**.

(37) Accordingly, the measured air A2 heated by the heater **130** which raises the temperature of the measured air A2 to the internal temperature T2, flows quickly while maintaining the internal temperature and contacts with the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160**. Thus, a more accurate particulate matter concentration measurement value can be obtained.

(38) In addition, insulation layers **125a** are respectively formed on inner wall surfaces of the heating block **115**, the spacer **119**, and the sensing passage **125**, or the heating block **115**, the spacer **119**, and the sensing passage **125** are made of an insulation material to minimize a heat loss of the measurement air A2 so that the measurement air A2 flows while maintaining the internal temperature.

(39) Moreover, it is preferable that the sensing passage **125** is designed such that a distance L between the heater **130** and the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** is shortened so that the measurement air A2 can rapidly come into contact with the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** while minimizing the heat loss of the measurement air A2.

(40) Since the width of the sensing passage **125** after the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** is no longer relevant to the sensing accuracy, the width of the pipeline is adjusted according to the width of the sensing block **117**. Furthermore, since the temperature or relative humidity of the measurement air A2 after being in contact with the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** is not important, the insulation layer **125a** may not be formed on the sensing passage **125** after the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160**.

(41) That is, the inflow passage **121**, the heating passage **123**, and the connecting passage **124** are designed to have a high antistatic performance, and the heating passage **123** and the connection passage **124** are preferably designed to have insulation performance as well as the antistatic performance.

(42) The light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** is combined with the inner wall surface of the sensing passage **125** to measure particulate matter contained in the measurement air A2. The particulate matter measured by the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** includes fine particulate matter having a particle diameter of 2.5 microns (μm) or less. The fine particulate matter concentration measured by the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** is transmitted to the control unit **180** through a connector **181**. The light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** may be implemented in various known forms.

(43) The outlet block **113** is combined with the top of the sensing block **117**. As illustrated in FIGS. 1 and 2, the outlet block **113** is fixedly coupled to the sensing block **117** and the heating block **115** using a first fastening member **113b**.

(44) The outlet block **113** has an outlet **113a**, and an outlet passage **127** communicating with the sensing passage **125**. The outlet passage **127** guides the measurement air A2 to the outlet **113a**.

(45) The outlet **113a** may be formed in the same direction as the inlet **111a**, or may be formed in the opposite direction. The outlet passage **127** may be bent from the outlet **113a** so as to prevent rain or snow from flowing into the outlet **113a**.

(46) FIGS. 5 to 7 illustrate various modifications of the airflow passage **120** of the present invention.

(47) FIG. 5 illustrates various directions of the air passage **120**. As illustrated in FIG. 5A, the airflow passage **120** according to a preferred embodiment of the present invention includes an inlet **111a** formed at a lower portion thereof and an outlet **113a** formed at an upper portion thereof, and outside air flows upward from the lower portion.

(48) As an occasion demands, the airflow passage **120a** may include an inlet **111a** formed on an upper portion thereof and an outlet **113a** formed at a lower portion thereof so that the outside air flows downward from the upper portion to measure the concentration of particulate matter.

(49) Meanwhile, as illustrated in FIG. 5B, an airflow passage **120b** may have an inlet **111a** formed at one side thereof and an outlet **113a** formed at the other side so that the outside air **A1** flows horizontally.

(50) Here, the heater **130**, the internal temperature humidity sensor **150**, and the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** are sequentially arranged from the inlet **111a** to the outlet **113a** regardless of the airflow direction of the airflow passages **120a** and **120b**.

(51) The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **100** according to the preferred embodiment of the present invention has one inlet **111a** and one outlet **113a**, and has one airflow passage **120** connecting the inlet **111a** and the outlet **113a** with each other.

(52) On the other hand, as illustrated in FIG. 6A, an airflow passage **120c** may have a plurality of inlets **111a** and **111a'**. The plurality of inlets **111a** and **111a'** may be formed in various directions of the inlet block **111**, and may be merged into one inflow passage **121** so that the air flows, or may be moved along a plurality of independent heating passages **123** and **123'** as illustrated in FIG. 6B.

(53) Each of the plurality of independent heating passages **123** and **123'** includes a heater **130** and an internal temperature-humidity sensor **150**.

(54) As illustrated in FIG. 6A, the measurement air **A2** getting in contact with the heater **130** through the independent heating passages **123** and **123'** moves along a sensing passage **125** merged into one, and then, may be discharged to the outside through an outlet passage **127** after concentration of particulate matter is measured in one light scattering particulate matter sensor **160**.

(55) As illustrated in FIGS. 7A and 7B, the independent heating passages **123** and **123'** may be respectively connected with the sensing passages **125** and **125'**.

(56) In this instance, as illustrated in FIG. 7A, the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** and the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** are disposed in only one among the sensing passages **125** and **125'**. Additionally, as illustrated in FIG. 7B, the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** and the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** may be disposed in all of the sensing passages **125** and **125'**.

(57) As illustrated in FIG. 7A, if the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** is disposed in only one among the sensing passages **125** and **125'**, since an amount of measured air is varied, a process of correcting the measured particulate matter concentration is added.

(58) Furthermore, the measurement air **A2** passing through each of the sensing passages **125** and **125'** may be discharged through one outlet passage **127** or may be individually discharged through the outlet passages **127** and a plurality of outlets **113a** connected to the outlet passages **127** (not shown).

(59) Meanwhile, as illustrated in FIGS. 7A and 7B, the airflow passages **120d** and **120e** has one heater **130**, one heating passage **123**, and a plurality of separated sensing passages **125** and **125'**.

(60) Additionally, all of the airflow passages **120** illustrated in FIGS. 5 to 7 have the inlets **111a** and the outlets **113a** which are illustrated in the same direction, but this is only an example, the inlets **111a** and the outlets **113a** may be arranged in opposite directions.

(61) Besides the above, the airflow passage **120** may be modified in various forms within a range in which the inlet **111a** and the outlet **113a** are connected, and the outside air can pass sequentially through the heater **130**, the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150**, and the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** as a closed route.

(62) The control unit **180** uniformly maintains the internal temperature **T2** or the internal relative humidity **W2** of the measurement air **A2** on the basis of the external temperature **T1** or the external relative humidity **W1** of the outside air **A1** sensed by the external temperature-humidity sensor **140**, so that the concentration of particulate matter measured by the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** can be accurately measured regardless of the relative humidity.

(63) As described above, when the relative humidity of the external temperature is high, water molecules evaporated in the air are absorbed into the particulate matter so that the particulate matter increases in volume. Furthermore, the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** mistakes

fine particulate matter for coarse particulate matter, thereby lowering accuracy in concentration measurement of the particulate matter.

(64) When the external relative humidity **W1** of the outside air **A1** is higher than a predetermined target relative humidity **Wt**, the control unit **180** heats the outside air **A1** by the heater **130** and operates the heater **130** so that the relative humidity **W2** of the measurement air **A2** is equal to the target relative humidity **Wt**.

(65) The control unit **180** according to a preferred embodiment of the present invention sets the target relative humidity **Wt** to 35%. This was determined through various studies by reflecting that a particle diameter of fine particulate matter gets larger at relative humidity of about 30% and most of national measuring stations set the deliquescence relative humidity to 35%. The target relative humidity **Wt** may change according to situations.

(66) When the target relative humidity **Wt** is set, the control unit **180** operates the heater **130** to control the relative humidity **W2** of the measurement air **A2** flowing along the heating passage **123** and the connection passage **124** to the target relative humidity **Wt**.

(67) The control unit **180** controls the internal relative humidity **W2** to reach the target relative humidity **Wt** using a control method, such as proportional-integral-derivative control (PID) in which the electric power of the heater **130** is increased when the internal relative humidity **W2** measured by the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** in real time is higher than the target relative humidity **Wt**, but when not so, the control unit **180** decreases the electric power of the heater **130**.

(68) Here, when the control unit **180** operates the heater **130** using the control method, the internal temperature **T2** of the measurement air **A2** flowing along the heating passage **123** and the connection passage **124** can exceed allowable safety temperature.

(69) Therefore, the control unit **180** calculates the target temperature **Tt** using the following Equation 1, controls the operation of the heater **130** based on the calculated target temperature **Tt**, and controls in such a way that the internal temperature of the measurement air **A2** does not exceed the safety temperature.

(70) Target temperature $T_t = A \times 237.3 / (7.5 - A)$, [Equation1] $A = \frac{7.5 \times T_2}{237.3 + T_2} + \log_{10} \left(\frac{W_2}{W_t} \right)$,

(71) wherein **T2** is internal temperature, **W2** is internal relative humidity, and **Wt** is target relative humidity.

(72) When the target temperature **Tt** is calculated, the control unit **180** operates the heater **130** to heat the outside air **A1** flowing through the heating passage **123** and to make the internal temperature **T2** of the measurement air **A2** reach the target temperature **Tt**.

(73) Here, the manager further sets the safety temperature in addition to the target temperature **Tt**. The safety temperature means temperature which does not make the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus malfunction, or which does not cause a change in chemical composition of particulate matter or fine particulate matter.

(74) The control unit **180** controls the heater **130** by an automatic control method, such as PID, so that the internal temperature **T2** becomes the target temperature **Tt** calculated by Equation 1. However, if the calculated target temperature **Tt** exceeds a predetermined safety temperature, the control unit **180** controls the heater **130** by changing the target temperature **Tt** to the safe temperature.

(75) In this process, if the internal temperature **T2** measured by operating the heater **130** exceeds the safety temperature, the control unit **180** immediately cuts off the power supply to the heater **130**.

(76) The control unit **180** periodically updates the target temperature **Tt** by Equation 1 at a predetermined time interval, and controls the operation of the heater **130**.

(77) In the above Equation 1, the target temperature is calculated using the internal temperature **T2**, the internal relative humidity **W2**, and the target relative humidity **Wt**.

(78) However, as occasion demands, the target temperature may be calculated using the external temperature **T1**, the external relative humidity **W1**, and the target relative humidity **Wt** measured by the external temperature-humidity sensor **140**. In this case, the target temperature **Tt** may be calculated using Equation 2 below.

(79) Targettemperature(**Tt**) = $A \times 237.3 / (7.5 - A)$, [Equation2] $A = \frac{7.5 \times T1}{237.3 + T1} + \log_{10} \left(\frac{W1}{Wt} \right)$,

(80) wherein **T1** is external temperature, **Tt** is target temperature, **W1** is external relative humidity, and **Wt** is target relative humidity.

(81) When the target temperature **Tt** is calculated using Equation 1, since the external relative humidity **W1** and the external temperature **T1** measured by the external temperature-humidity sensor **140** are not required, the external temperature-humidity sensor **140** is not required, and thus, the configuration of the system can be simplified.

(82) The control unit **180** may selectively use any one of the two methods or may use the two methods interchangeably.

(83) Meanwhile, when the heater **130** is operated to heat the internal temperature of the measurement air **A2** to the target temperature, the control unit **180** corrects the particulate matter concentration measured by the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160**.

(84) When heated by the heater **130**, the relative humidity **W2** of the measurement air **A2** is lower than the initial external relative humidity **W1**. Accordingly, the internal temperature **T2** of the measurement air **A2** flowing into the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** is higher than the external temperature **T1**. As the temperature of the measurement air **A2** increases, the volume of the measurement air **A2** increases more than that of the outside air **A1**.

(85) Since the particulate matter concentration is measured by the weight of particulate matter per unit volume of air, a process of correcting the particulate matter concentration value calculated by the increased volume is required.

(86) Correction of the particulate matter concentration value is performed by Equation 3 below. Corrected particulate matter concentration=(particulate matter concentration measured in light scattering particulate matter sensor) $\times$ (273+internal temperature)/(273+external temperature) [Equation 3]

(87) The particulate matter measuring process using the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **100** according to the present invention will be described with reference to FIGS. 1 to 8.

(88) The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus **100** of the present invention is installed at a measuring position. An inlet **111a** is located at a lower portion of the casing **110**, and an outlet **113a** is located at an upper portion of the casing **110**.

(89) The external temperature-humidity sensor **140** located outside the casing **110** measures the external temperature **T1** and the external relative humidity **W1** of the outside air **A1** and transmits the measured external temperature **T1** and the external relative humidity **W1** to the control unit **180** (**S110**). The control unit **180** determines whether the transmitted external relative humidity **W1** is lower than the predetermined target relative humidity **Wt** (**S120**).

(90) When the external relative humidity **W1** is lower than the predetermined target relative humidity **Wt**, the control unit **180** cuts off the power supply to the heater **130** so that the heater **130** is not operated (**S130**).

(91) The outside air **A1** flows through the inlet **111a**, and the outside air **A1** is moved along the inflow passage **121** to the heating passage **123**. In this instance, an antistatic layer **121a** is formed on the inner wall surface of the inflow passage **121** to prevent the particulate matter from being adhered onto the inner wall surface by static electricity, and the outside air **A1** introduced into the inlet **111a** may be moved to the heating passage **123**.

(92) Accordingly, as illustrated in FIG. 2, the outside air **A1** introduced into the inlet **111a** flows along the inflow passage **121** and the heating passage **123**, and is introduced into the light

scattering particulate matter sensor **160** via the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** in a non-heated state.

(93) The particulate matter concentration of the outside air (measurement air) that is not heated in the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160** is measured, and the particulate matter concentration measured by the control unit **180** is transmitted (S170). The control unit **180** outputs the measured particulate matter concentration to the outside. (S190)

(94) On the other hand, if the external relative humidity $W1$ is higher than the predetermined target relative humidity Wt , the control unit **180** calculates the target temperature at which the relative humidity becomes the target relative humidity (S140). The target temperature may be calculated by Equation 1 above.

(95) When the target temperature is calculated, the control unit **180** supplies power to the heater **130** to operate the heater **130** (S150). The outside air $A1$ flowing into the heating passage **123** gets in contact with the heater **130** and is heated. The heated measurement air $A2$ gets in contact with the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150**, and the internal temperature $T2$ or the internal relative humidity $W2$ is measured.

(96) When the internal temperature $T2$ measured by the internal temperature-humidity sensor **150** is the same as the target temperature Tt , the internal temperature $T2$ is supplied to the sensing passage **125** to get in contact with the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160**, and the particulate matter concentration is measured (S170).

(97) When the particulate matter concentration is measured by the light scattering particulate matter sensor **160**, the control unit **180** corrects the particulate matter concentration by Equation 3 (S180), and outputs the particulate matter concentration (S190).

(98) As described above, the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the present invention is capable of lowering relative humidity and increasing accuracy in concentration measurement of particulate matter by heating outside air by the heater when the relative humidity of the outside air is high.

(99) In addition, an antistatic layer is formed on the inner wall surface of the airflow passage through which the outside air flows, or the airflow passage is made of an antistatic material. Accordingly, the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the present invention can prevent particulate matter from adhering on the inflow passage by static electricity, thereby solving the problem that there is an error in the particulate matter measurement result.

(100) Additionally, the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to the present invention has the insulation layer formed on the inner wall surface of the sensing flow passage extending from the heater to the light scattering particulate matter sensor, thereby minimizing heat loss of the measured air having the increased temperature and securing the reliability in the measurement result of the particulate matter concentration.

(101) The technical thoughts of the present invention have been described hereinafter.

(102) It is to be appreciated that those skilled in the art can change or modify the embodiments from the above description in various ways. Although it is not clearly illustrated or described herein, it is to be appreciated that those skilled in the art can change or modify the embodiments from the above description in various ways without departing from the scope and spirit of the present invention and such changes and modifications belong to the scope of the present invention. While the present invention has been described with reference to the particular illustrative embodiments, it is not to be restricted by the embodiments but only by the appended claims.

Claims

1. A light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus which measures particulate matter concentration in outside air in a light scattering method, the apparatus comprising: a casing provided with an inlet into which outside air flows, and an outlet through which measurement air is

discharged, the particulate matter concentration of the measurement air having been measured; an airflow passage which connects the inlet and the outlet in the casing and through which outside air moves; a heater disposed in the airflow passage; a light scattering particulate matter sensor disposed in the airflow passage to measure concentration of particulate matter of the measurement air; an internal temperature-humidity sensor disposed in the airflow passage to measure temperature and relative humidity of the measurement air; and a control unit configured to control power supply to the heater based on the temperature and the relative humidity measured by the internal temperature-humidity sensor, wherein the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus is configured to be mounted such that the outlet is positioned to be more elevated than the inlet, wherein the light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus is configured to measure particulate matter concentration in the outside air by using convective movement of the outside air in the airflow passage based on operation of the heater, wherein the heater, the internal temperature-humidity sensor, the light scattering particulate matter sensor are positioned sequentially in the airflow passage from the inlet to the outlet, wherein the control unit is configured to control electric power of the heater based on the relative humidity measured by the internal temperature-humidity sensor in order to heat the outside air, moving to the outlet based on the convective movement, to a target temperature for reaching a predetermined target relative humidity, and wherein the airflow passage including the light scattering particulate matter sensor is narrower than the airflow passage including the heater and the internal temperature-humidity sensor such that the convective movement of air in the airflow passage is increased and the particulate matter concentration is more accurately measured.

2. The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to claim 1, wherein an air flow fan is disposed on the airflow passage to forcibly move the outside air.

3. The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to claim 2, wherein the airflow passage includes a plurality of internal branch passages extending from the heater to the outlet, and wherein the internal temperature-humidity sensor and the light scattering particulate matter sensor are disposed in any one among the internal branch passages.

4. The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to claim 2, wherein the airflow passage includes a plurality of internal branch passages extending from the heater to the outlet, and wherein each of the plurality of internal branch passages includes the internal temperature-humidity sensor and the light scattering particulate matter sensor.

5. The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to claim 2, wherein the airflow passage further comprises: an inflow passage extending from the inlet to the heater, and an outlet passage extending from the light scattering particulate matter sensor to the outlet.

6. The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to claim 5, wherein insulation layers made of an insulation material are respectively disposed on inner wall surfaces of the heating passage and the sensing passage.

7. The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to claim 6, wherein antistatic layers made of an antistatic material are respectively disposed on surfaces of the inflow passage, the heating passage, and the sensing passage.

8. The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to claim 7, further comprising: an external temperature-humidity sensor disposed outside the casing to measure temperature and the relative humidity of the outside air, wherein the control unit operates the heater when an external relative humidity of the outside air measured by the external temperature-humidity sensor is higher than the predetermined target relative humidity, to heat the outside air until the external relative humidity of the outside air reaches a target relative humidity.

9. The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to claim 2, wherein the air flow fan is configured such that flow of air in a direction opposite to gravitational pull is generated at least in the sensing passage.

10. The light scattering particulate matter measuring apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the airflow passage is configured to channel air either upward or laterally but not downward.
